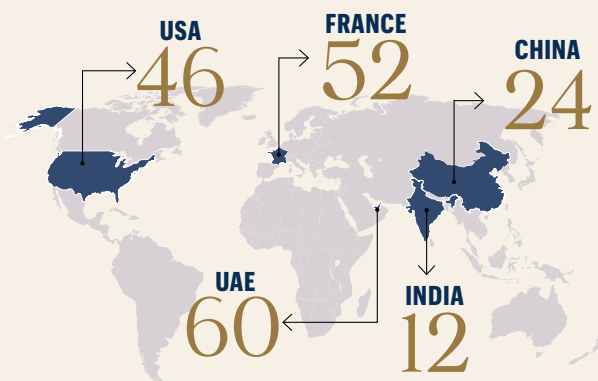


THE PULSE OF PERFUME

- The Middle East is a key market for luxury goods with growing demand for attar-based products and a rise in high-end stores offering customised fragrances
- Europe remains a major player in the global market, driven by strong demand for luxury, traditional, and handcrafted fragrances in France, Italy, and the UK



NOTE ESTIMATED PER CAPITA SPENDING GLOBALLY IN \$; DATA AS OF JUNE 2025

SOURCE BRICKWORK RATINGS

luxury strategist and founder of Luxury Connect Business School.

This maturity is reflected in spending patterns. According to Bahety, Indian customers are comfortable paying \$120–150 (₹10,000–₹12,000) for luxury fragrances. For first-time buyers, discovery sets, or smaller bottles priced at \$50–150 (₹5,000–₹12,000), serve as accessible entry points. Once they find a scent they love, they often upgrade to larger bottles—signalling a market that is learning, experimenting, and evolving.

Global players are already seeing results. “India is one of the most exciting growth markets globally,” says Vishal Gurtu, Managing Director, Tarz Distribution, distributor partner for Davidoff perfume. “A good example is Davidoff Cool Elixir, which, despite premium pricing of around ₹6,000 for 50 ml, has exceeded expectations (demand) in India.”

Consumers are willing to trade up when a brand resonates with their aspirations. Gurtu believes that

by understanding their preferences and social touch-points, the company can engage them more meaningfully and build lasting resonance.

Alongside global maisons that sell more expensive perfumes, homegrown players are claiming their space in luxury with products that are more pocket friendly. From Lucknow’s ISAK Fragrances to Gurugram-based Naso Profumi, New Delhi’s Olfa Originals, Mumbai-born design atelier Good Earth, and Ayurveda-inspired Forest Essentials, Indian brands are creating distinctive blends that fuse tradition with modernity.

K **RATI TANDON, CO-FOUNDER** of Boond Fragrances—a luxury *attar* label from Kannauj—believes the two categories can coexist. “Consumers may wear natural oils during festivals or certain occasions while reserving a Chanel for work. It’s not an either-or choice,” she says. Boond’s handcrafted *attars* start at ₹1,699 for 6 ml.

Yet, perception remains a challenge. “In Europe, buyers pay a premium for sustainable, handcrafted products. In India, such craftsmanship is undervalued, not due to price but perception,” Tandon adds.

Adding to that perspective, Rishi Verma, founder of NEESH Perfumes—headquartered in Paris and India—draws a parallel with fashion. He says that just as Indian couture now stands alongside Parisian and Italian houses, Indian luxury perfume brands rooted in centuries-old olfactory traditions have the potential to command global recognition.

“India has historically been the cradle of perfumery—Kannauj, *attars*, and botanicals are world-renowned. If positioned with the right storytelling, craftsmanship, and consistency, Indian fragrance brands can redefine the global niche category,” he says. The luxury brand from India is selling across the US, Europe, India, Malaysia, Singapore, Paris, and the UAE.

Platforms like Tira, Reliance Retail’s omnichannel beauty venture, suggest the divide between global and Indian luxury brands is narrowing. Infusing Indian notes like *mogra* (jasmine), saffron, and cardamom with global accords such as oud and Amberwood, homegrown perfumers are creating an “Indianised” palette with global appeal. Consumers, they note, are increasingly open to experimenting with both.

The numbers reaffirm the momentum. Kotak Securities estimates that India’s fragrance user base will reach 121 million, with penetration increasing from 6.2% in 2025 to 8.2% by 2029. The overall beauty and personal care (BPC) industry is projected to touch \$34 billion.